this regard. Some other factors like 'unemployment, poverty, lack of education, social rejection, an unhappy family environment, etc. played a role in indoctrination of culturally dispossessed young men'.

The indulgence of these elements in sectarian violence resulted in numerous clashes and killings over years. Data for three years can provide a fair glimpse of the consequences of sectarian violence during that period (Policy Brief; Figure 3.1).

The following three organisations were responsible for this phase: (1) The Sipah-e-Sahaba Pakistan (SSP), a Sunni Deobandi organisation; (2) Sipah-e-Muhammad Pakistan (SMP) a Shi'a organisation; and (3) Lashkar-e-Jhangvi, an ultra-militant splinter group of SSP.

SIPAH-E-SAHABA PAKISTAN (SSP)

This Sunni Deobandi militant sectarian organisation was formed in Jhang city in 1985 in retaliation to the Shi'a sectarian surge after the Iranian Islamic Revolution of 1979. The Sunni elements felt that the Shi'as of Jhang, who were in majority there, became more aggressive in practising that part of their sect, which affected them. That part was a blasphemous attitude towards the reverent Companions of Prophet Muhammad, known as *Sahaba*. The main targets of these sacrilegious attacks were usually Abu Bakr, Umar and Usman, who are known as Pious Caliphs (*Khulfa-e-Rashdeen*), and also Hazrat Ayesha, the wife of the Prophet. This practice irritated and instigated the Sunni Deobandis

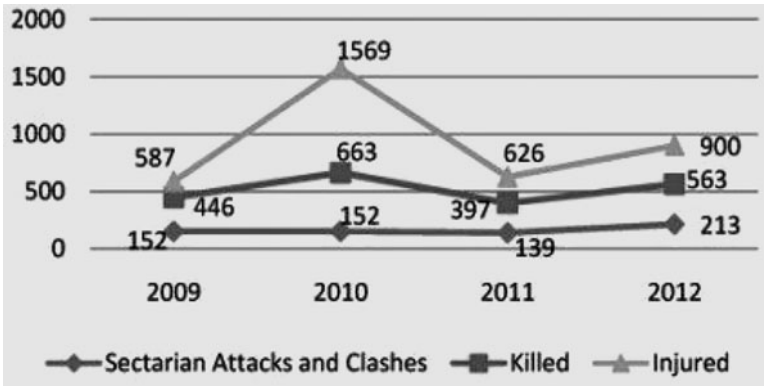


Figure 3.1 Trends of sectarian violence (2009–12).